

Sara Siqueira

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EXPERIENCE

NIANTIC SPATIAL | FOUNDING UX RESEARCHER

May 2025 – Present | San Francisco, CA

- As the founding UX researcher, I established foundational UX processes (Critical User Journeys, CUJ Health Audits) to aid the company's transition from B2C to B2B and collaborate with Design, Engineering, PM, and GTM to take novel geospatial AI products 0 to 1.
- Led a research program to define the company's spatial AI product strategy (executive interviews, market research, requirements definition, prototype evaluation, benchmarking). Aligned leadership and EPD orgs on a unified roadmap and prototype development plan, which generated 40+ new qualified leads and 2 production customers.
- Architected an AI-powered living research repository, replacing fragmented studies with a single, democratized source of truth for cross-functional teams.
- Collaborated with engineering to evaluate user sentiment in agentic workflows, defining survey instruments to operationalize trust and usefulness into clear research questions.
- Initiated and led a 1-week study to map a prospect's end users' workflows, building a data-driven design partnership proposal, leading to a signed deal.
- Planned and conducted field research in complex real-world environments for mapping and localization products (Scaniverse, Visual Positioning System 2.0) to understand end user behaviors, perceptions, and pain points. Translated insights into customer proposals worth \$2m.
- Own end-to-end research execution from identifying research needs and prioritization to analysis, presentations, and strategic recommendations.

NIANTIC LABS | UX RESEARCHER

September 2022 – May 2025 | San Francisco, CA

- Led UXR for Niantic's Visual Positioning System (VPS), mapping products including Scaniverse, and augmented reality (AR) experiences. My research led to a 30+% increase in VPS localization success rates in Pokémon GO, improvements in map management tools for developers, and rapid UX iterations that led to users creating higher quality 3D scans.
- Led UX on the first AR experience in Pokémon GO, reaching millions of players and engaging 50k+ active users. Conducted global research studies localized in 5+ languages, collating survey and telemetry data to evaluate experience quality and usage patterns across regions.
- Defined best practices for VPS and AR experiences by studying how users perceived and trusted AI-driven localization, using a mixed-method approach to set acceptability thresholds. Created the first user-centric internal benchmarks that guided launch readiness decisions.
- Presented research at the CHI conference in Yokohama, Japan.

EDUCATION

TUFTS UNIVERSITY | B.S. IN COGNITIVE & BRAIN SCIENCES

Minor in Economics

RESEARCH

TUFTS APPLIED COGNITION LAB | RESEARCH ASSISTANT

September 2019 – May 2022 | Medford, MA

- Led research projects on attention, multitasking behavior, and cognitive performance under stress
- Design study protocols and surveys, develop R scripts to analyze quantitative and qualitative data, review literature, run participants; present findings through research papers, data visualization, and presentations

SKILLS

Tools: Claude, Figma, Alchemer, Qualtrics, NVivo, R, C++

Research Methods: User interviews, usability testing, diary studies, surveys, MaxDiff, A/B testing, Critical User Journey (CUJ) definition and task analysis, participatory design, field research (contextual inquiry), market segmentation